total military expenditure rose to US$1981 in 2020. It is an increase of 2.6 percent in real terms from 2019. The five biggest spenders United States, China, India, Russia, and the UK, accounted for 62 percent of global military expenditure. The more interesting facet of the report is that China's military spending grew for the 26th consecutive year. It is estimated that China has spent US$252 billion in 2020, representing an increase of 1.9 percent over 2019 and 76 percent over the decade 2011–2020. Likewise, Russia's military expenditure increased by 2.5 percent in 2020 to reach US$61.7 billion. However, there is a slight shortfall in Russia's military spending from its military budget compared to previous years (SIPRI 2021).

Russian and Chinese cooperation, therefore, increased ever before, with their state representatives meeting frequently. Russian presidential aide Yuri Ushakov, on June 22, 2016, during Putin's visit to Beijing, stated that Russia and China would adhere to similar or close potions literally on all critical issues of world affairs. Russia and China cooperate at the international sites, prominently, United Nations, BRICS, and SCO (Metzel 2016). So, in the twenty-first century, two intrinsic factors will affect Russia and China's foreign policy. First is continuing economic globalization, and second is a gradual decline of Western power. In economic globalization, these two countries will continue to seek to preserve a regional and global power status by creating new alliances in international relations. However, what was earlier a soft model of an exclusive military club in international relations will now be an inclusive model driven by countries' specific economic and political needs (Tsygankov 2010). However, the big question is, how will the other emerging countries react to the Russian federation and China's. That is the way the Ukraine crisis is a crucial phase of emerging international relations.

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